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Hong Kong Property

2026 Long-term Housing Strategy: Tighter Supply, Resilient Demand

CITI'S TAKE

10-year housing forecast: tighter private supply but rising demand from talents & students — The 2026 long-term housing strategy (LTHS, [link](#)) reinforces our positive view on HK residential, with tightening private supply but resilient demand. [1] 10-year supply target is 420k units, including 126k private units, down 5%yoy & 34% over 12 years. [2] demand projection remains broadly stable at 419k units (flat yoy or -8% over 12 years). as higher non-local student demand (+45%yoy or +7.2k units) offsets slower household formation. [3] We see demand assumptions as prudent: LTHS projects only 186.8k new households in '27-'36 on 418k population growth by '37 (to 8.06mn), versus 304k households created on just 200k population growth in 2015-25, amid continued household downsizing. [4] We see demand upside from talent & student inflows, with HK's carried-interest tax reform providing a potential near-term catalyst to attract financial professionals.

Private housing supply target cut to 12.6k p.a. (-34% vs FY16-25) —The latest private supply target of 126k units is down 5%yoy (vs FY26-35) & 34% below the 190k-unit target for FY16-25, despite broadly stable demand (flat yoy; -8% vs a decade ago), with 70/30 public/ private split. With new supply more concentrated on the Northern Metropolis, we see an even tighter supply outlook for core districts.

Demand & household formation forecast looks conservative — We believe official demand projection could underestimate future household formation. In 2015-25 (10 years), HK population increased by only 200k to 7.5mn, and no. of households rose by 304k to 2.77mn. In 1H26 alone, population rose 9.6k with 19.3k new households. The implied sub-one-person size of incremental households suggests demand was driven by both population growth & existing households split. Yet, despite assuming a much larger 418k population increase to 8.06mn by 2037E (doubled from 200k growth in 2015-25), the LTHS projects only 186.8k new households, just 61% of the 2015-25 increase. If household sizes continue to shrink, we see meaningful upside to official housing demand forecasts.

Student inflows offer further demand upside — Student visas grew by 51k in 2015-25 while the 100k non-local students target by 2030E implies growth of only 4k p.a under the Five-Year Plan. The resulting demand forecast of 2.3k units (assuming 2 students per units), is already +45%yoy & doubled that of 2years ago. We see further upside as HK's accelerates its push to become an education hub.

Private completion falls & head toward 15k units — Private completion is expected to decline to 15.4k units in '27E ('25: 18.4k, '26E 17.0k), per Ratings & Valuation Dept. We expect it to remain at similarly low levels in '28E based on land supply in '23-25. 8M26 primary sales +10%yoy to 14.3k units. We est. '26E sales +3%yoy to 21.1k.

Stay positive into 2027E: home price +6%; new high rent — We remain positive on residential fundamentals & forecast 2027E home price & rent +6%, despite share price consolidation. While elevated US rates could continue to weigh on near-term sector performance, we expect landlords to outperform developers in 4Q26E given improving retail reversions. *Stock picks*: Swire Prop, Wharf REIC, Link REIT, SHKP.

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¹See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

Figure 1. Hong Kong Long Term Housing Strategy: Long-term Housing Supply Targets

(Each 10-year period supply target was set by the government based on its long-term housing demand projection)

Period	Share of Public Housing within Total Supply (%)	Total Housing Supply Govt Target (units)	Public Housing Supply Govt Target (units)	Private Housing Supply Govt Target (units)
2015-16 to 2024-25	60%	480,000	290,000	190,000
2016-17 to 2025-26	61%	460,000	280,000	180,000
2017-18 to 2026-27	61%	460,000	280,000	180,000
2018-19 to 2027-28	61%	460,000	280,000	180,000
2019-20 to 2028-29	70%	450,000	315,000	135,000
2020-21 to 2029-30	70%	430,000	301,000	129,000
2021-22 to 2030-31	70%	430,000	301,000	129,000
2022-23 to 2031-32	70%	430,000	301,000	129,000
2023-24 to 2032-33	70%	430,000	301,000	129,000
2024-25 to 2033-34	70%	440,000	308,000	132,000
2025-26 to 2034-35	70%	440,000	308,000	132,000
2026-27 to 2035-36	70%	420,000	294,000	126,000
YoY change in govt target Latest vs. 12 years ago	-	-5%	-5%	-5%
	+10pts	-13%	1%	-34%

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Source: Housing Bureau, Citi Research

Figure 2. Hong Kong Long Term Housing Strategy: Long-term Housing Demand Projection

Forecast Period	Household Formation	Redevelopment	Inadequately Housed Households	Mobile Residents	Non-local Students	Non-local Buyers Taking Units Off Market	Vacancy Adjustment	Total Housing Demand Govt Estimate (post vacancy adj.) Mid-point (units)
2016-17 to 2025-26	247,800	45,400	106,600	7,000	9,000	20,700	18,500	455,000
2017-18 to 2026-27	237,700	62,900	105,500	7,000	7,800	18,600	17,500	457,000
2018-19 to 2027-28	234,400	60,400	115,100	7,000	5,300	18,900	13,900	455,000
2019-20 to 2028-29	222,100	63,500	116,600	7,000	6,100	17,100	12,600	445,000
2020-21 to 2029-30	209,800	64,000	119,100	7,000	7,300	15,900	1,900	425,000
2021-22 to 2030-31	205,200	64,300	122,000	7,000	7,300	14,300	7,900	428,000
2022-23 to 2031-32	197,300	65,300	127,100	7,000	6,600	12,300	7,200	422,800
2023-24 to 2032-33	189,400	72,400	127,500	7,000	5,400	11,800	7,500	421,000
2024-25 to 2033-34	200,600	71,600	127,500	7,000	6,600	11,000	7,700	432,000
2025-26 to 2034-35	197,300	73,800	127,500	5,000	10,800	15,900	7,700	438,000
2026-27 to 2035-36	194,000	52,500	127,500	5,000	15,900	15,600	8,600	419,100
2027-28 to 2036-37	186,800	53,200	127,500	5,000	23,100	15,900	7,800	419,300
YoY change in LTHS projection Latest vs. 12 years ago	-4%	1%	0%	0%	45%	2%	-9%	0%
	-25%	17%	20%	-29%	157%	-23%	-58%	-8%

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Source: Housing Bureau, Citi Research

Figure 3. Projected Housing Demand by LT Housing Strategy Steering Committee for FY27-36 (10-year annual avg)

(units)	Lower Range Govt Projection	Mid-point Govt Projection	Upper Range Govt Projection	Citi est allocation of Govt projection	Private (Mid-point)	Public (Mid-point)
Net increase in new households	17,370	18,680	19,990	30% private, 70% public	5,604	13,076
Households displaced by redevelopment	5,320	5,320	5,320		-	-
- redevelopment of public housing	3,270	3,270	3,270	Public	-	3,270
- redevelopment of private housing	2,050	2,050	2,050	Private	2,050	-
Inadequately housed households	12,750	12,750	12,750	Public	-	12,750
Mobile residents	500	500	500	Private	500	-
Non-local students	2,310	2,310	2,310	Private	2,310	-
Non-local buyers who take units off market	1,590	1,590	1,590	Private	1,590	-
Adjustments for vacant units in private sector	780	780	780	Private	780	-
Total housing demand (Govt projection)	40,620	41,930	43,240			
- Private housing demand (Citi est allocation)	12,441	12,834	13,227		12,834	
- Public housing demand (Citi est allocation)	28,179	29,096	30,013			29,096

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Source: Housing Bureau, Citi Research estimates



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Figure 4. YoY Change in LTHS Projected Housing Demand: FY27-36 vs FY26-35

(units)	Change abs			Change YoY			Previous 2026-2035 Govt Target		
	Lower Range Govt Projection	Mid-point Govt Projection	Upper Range Govt Projection	Lower Range Govt Projection	Mid-point Govt Projection	Upper Range Govt Projection	Lower Range Govt Projection	Mid-point Govt Projection	Upper Range Govt Projection
Net increase in new households	(670)	(720)	(770)	-4%	-4%	-4%	18,040	19,400	20,760
Households displaced by redevelopment	70	70	70	1%	1%	1%	5,250	5,250	5,250
- redevelopment of public housing	240	240	240	8%	8%	8%	3,030	3,030	3,030
- redevelopment of private housing	(170)	(170)	(170)	-8%	-8%	-8%	2,220	2,220	2,220
Inadequately housed households	0	0	0	0%	0%	0%	12,750	12,750	12,750
Mobile residents	0	0	0	0%	0%	0%	500	500	500
Non-local students	720	720	720	45%	45%	45%	1,590	1,590	1,590
Non-local buyers who take units off market	30	30	30	2%	2%	2%	1,560	1,560	1,560
Adjustments for vacant units in private sector	(80)	(80)	(80)	-9%	-9%	-9%	860	860	860
Total housing demand (Govt projection)	70	20	(30)	0%	0%	0%	40,550	41,910	43,270
- Private housing demand (Citi est allocation)	299	284	269	2%	2%	2%	12,142	12,550	12,958
- Public housing demand (Citi est allocation)	(229)	(264)	(299)	-1%	-1%	-1%	28,408	29,360	30,312

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Source: Housing Bureau, Citi Research estimates

Figure 5. 10-Year Population and Household Formation Targets

(people)	# Population	# Household	Implied Household Size
2015	7,309,700	2,471,100	2.96
2025	7,508,700	2,774,900	2.71
2015-25 Actual	199,000	303,800	0.66
Jun-2026	7,518,300	2,794,200	2.69
1H26 Net Change	9,600	19,300	0.50
2027	7,638,700	N/A	N/A
2037	8,057,200	N/A	N/A
2027-37 Govt Target	418,500	186,800	2.24

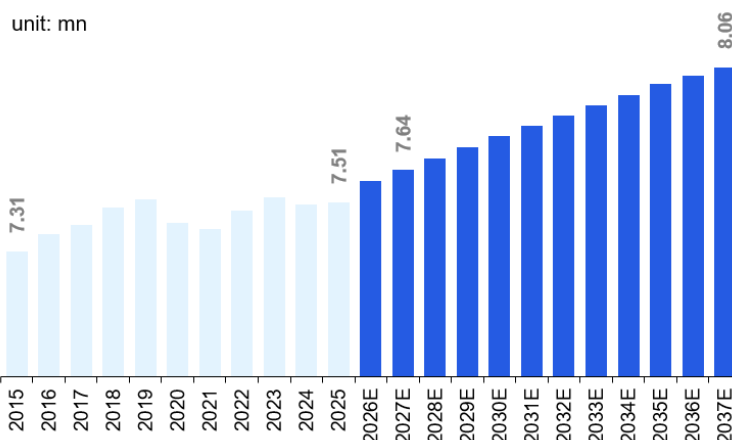
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Source: Census & Statistics Department, Housing Bureau, Citi Research

Note: (1) An implied household size of less than 1.0 during a given period suggests that household growth is being driven not only by new population, but also by the downsizing or splitting of existing households.

(2) The Census & Statistics Department published a HK population projection till 2046 in August 2023.

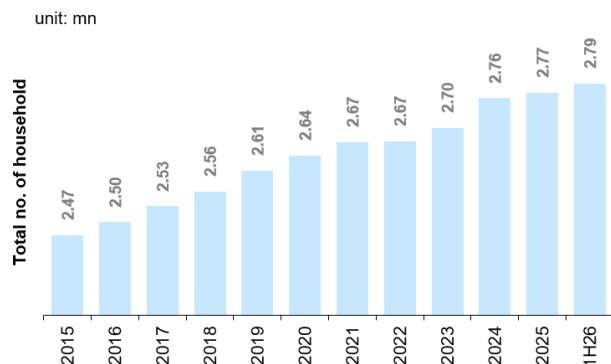
Figure 6. Hong Kong Population Projections (in mn)



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Source: HK Census and Statistics Department, Citi Research estimates

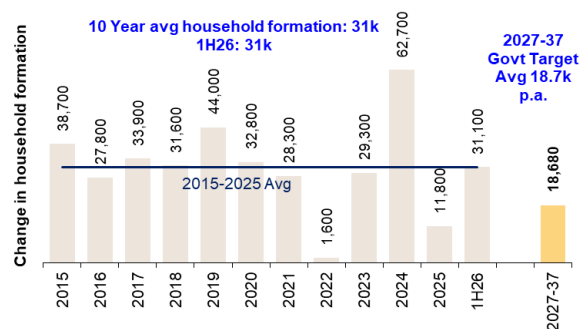
Figure 7. Total Number of Households (in mn)



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Source: HK Census and Statistics Department, Citi Research

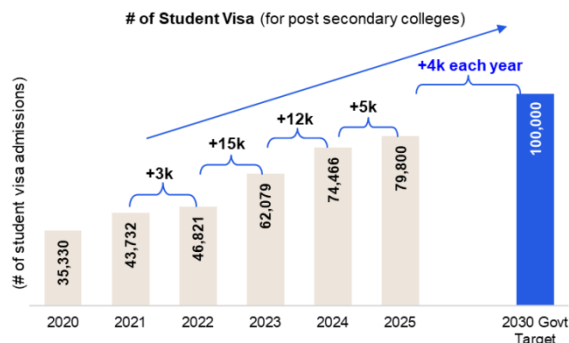
Figure 8. Household Formation



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Source: HK Census and Statistics Department, Housing Bureau, Citi Research

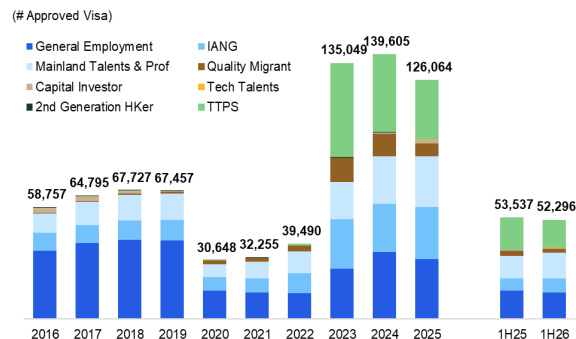
Figure 9. Targeting 100k Non-Local Students by '30E



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Source: HK Five Year Plan, Immigration Department, Citi Research

Figure 10. Talent Visa Approvals



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Source: Immigration Department, Citi Research

Figure 11. Housing Completion Forecasts

(units)	Private Housing Completion Citi Estimate	Public Housing Completion Gov't Target	Total Completion	Share of Public Housing within Total Completion (%)
2027	15,362	33,200	48,562	68%
2028	15,233	33,000	48,233	68%
2029	18,450	41,700	60,150	69%
2030	18,980	30,800	49,780	62%
2031	14,434	37,200	51,634	72%
5-Year Total	82,459	176,000	258,459	68%

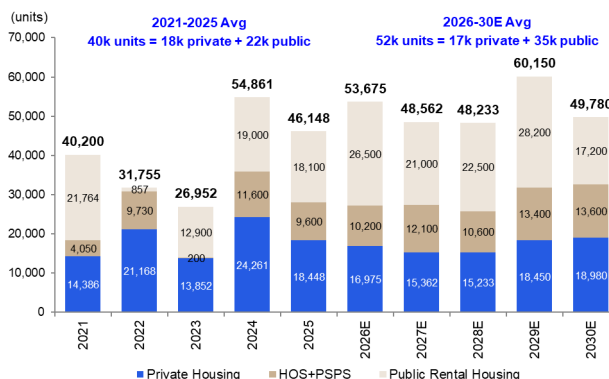
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Source: Housing Bureau, Ratings & Valuation Department, Citi Research estimates



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Figure 12. Housing Completion Forecasts



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Source: Housing Bureau, Ratings & Valuation Department, Citi Research estimates

Figure 13. Primary Housing Transaction Volume

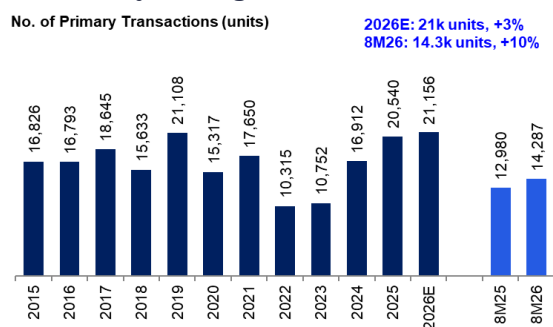


Figure 14. Primary Housing Transaction Value

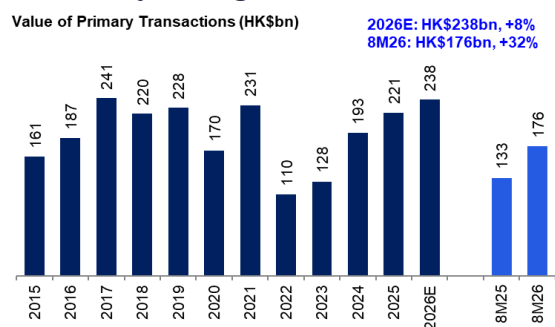


Figure 15. Secondary Housing Transaction Volume

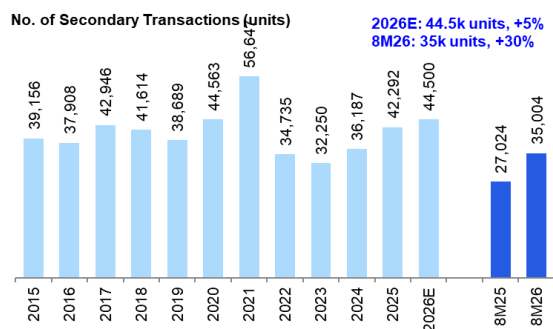
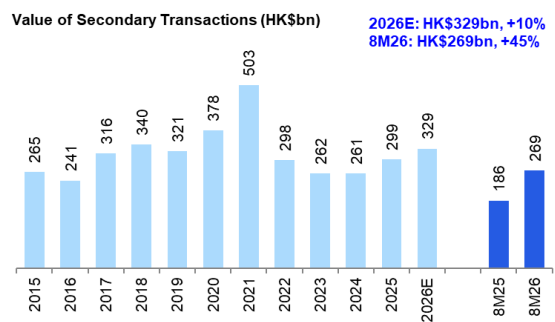


Figure 16. Secondary Housing Transaction Value



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Source: Land Registry, Citi Research estimates

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Source: Land Registry, Citi Research estimates

Figure 17. HK Property Sector — Valuations (5-Oct-2026 close) Citi Rating: 1 – Buy; 2 – Neutral; 3 – Sell; H – High Risk

Stock	RIC	5-Oct-26 Price	Mkt Cap (USDm)	Citi Rating	Est. NAV	NAV Disc	Target Price	P/E FY26E	P/E FY27E	P/E FY28E	P/B FY26E	P/B FY27E	P/B FY28E	Yield FY26E	Yield FY27E	Yield FY28E
Wharf	0004.HK	18.61	7,248	3	43.55	-57%	19.41	13.8	13.3	12.2	0.4	0.4	0.4	3.2%	2.1%	2.1%
Henderson Land	0012.HK	25.50	15,733	1	57.67	-56%	34.60	14.3	12.4	11.7	0.4	0.4	0.4	4.9%	4.9%	4.9%
Hysan	0014.HK	15.32	2,005	3	45.74	-67%	15.69	11.1	11.6	11.5	0.2	0.2	0.2	7.0%	7.0%	7.0%
SHK Properties	0016.HK	105.00	38,775	1	210.00	-50%	168.30	13.3	12.4	11.7	0.5	0.5	0.5	3.7%	4.0%	4.2%
New World Dev	0017.HK	5.70	1,828	2	22.65	-75%	6.90	N/A	N/A	N/A	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
MTRC	0066.HK	30.60	24,274	3	35.22	-13%	30.00	9.1	18.4	28.6	0.9	0.9	0.9	4.3%	4.3%	4.3%
Sino Land	0083.HK	10.01	12,229	1	18.93	-47%	14.30	19.6	19.1	18.5	0.6	0.6	0.6	5.8%	5.8%	5.8%
Hang Lung Ppt	0101.HK	6.48	4,293	1	25.74	-75%	10.30	11.4	10.8	10.4	0.2	0.2	0.2	8.0%	8.0%	8.0%
Kerry Prop	0683.HK	17.42	3,222	1	64.49	-73%	25.80	12.6	6.9	4.9	0.2	0.2	0.2	7.7%	7.7%	7.7%
Fortune REIT	0778.HK	4.22	1,110	1	10.46	-60%	6.05	14.6	15.2	15.4	0.3	0.3	0.4	8.0%	7.7%	7.6%
Link REIT	0823.HK	36.40	12,010	1	55.96	-35%	44.80	14.3	14.7	14.7	0.6	0.6	0.6	7.0%	6.8%	6.8%
CK Asset	1113.HK	45.36	20,231	1	99.18	-54%	54.80	12.6	12.3	11.6	0.4	0.4	0.4	4.1%	4.2%	4.5%
Swire Properties	1972.HK	23.76	17,433	1	52.73	-55%	29.00	16.2	14.1	14.0	0.5	0.5	0.5	5.1%	5.3%	5.6%
Wharf REIC	1997.HK	29.46	11,399	1	60.00	-51%	36.00	14.0	13.7	13.4	0.5	0.5	0.5	6.4%	6.6%	6.7%
Champion REIT	2778.HK	2.00	1,570	3	5.09	-61%	2.05	15.6	15.8	15.8	0.3	0.3	0.3	5.8%	5.7%	5.7%
Hongkong Land	HKLD.SI	7.99	17,024	1	14.99	-47%	9.90	33.8	30.5	26.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	3.4%	3.6%	3.9%
Average							-47%	15.2	15.5	15.9	0.5	0.5	0.5	4.7%	4.8%	4.9%

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Source: DataCentral, Citi Research estimates Note: listed in the order of stock code; N.M stands for "not meaningful" due to loss-making

Companies Mentioned:

Champion REIT (2778.HK; HK\$2.05; 3; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | CK Asset (1113.HK; HK\$45.22; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Fortune REIT (0778.HK; HK\$4.31; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Hang Lung Props (0101.HK; HK\$6.53; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Henderson Land (0012.HK; HK\$25.56; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Hongkong Land (HKLD.SI; US\$7.99; 1; 05 Oct 26; 17:06) | Hysan Development (0014.HK; HK\$15.31; 3; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Kerry Props (0683.HK; HK\$17.51; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Link REIT (0823.HK; HK\$36.86; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | MTR (0066.HK; HK\$31.12; 3; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | New World Development (0017.HK; HK\$5.5; 2; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | SHK Properties (0016.HK; HK\$104.4; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Sino Land (0083.HK; HK\$10.03; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Swire Properties (1972.HK; HK\$23.76; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Wharf (Holdings) (0004.HK; HK\$18.52; 3; 06 Oct 26; 16:10) | Wharf REIC (1997.HK; HK\$29.84; 1; 06 Oct 26; 16:10)



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